

Omer Ali

CONTACT INFORMATION

Department of Economics, 4506 Wesley W. Posvar Hall
230 South Bouquet Street, Pittsburgh, PA 15260
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Professor of Economics, University of Pittsburgh	2023–present
NSF Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Duke University	2021–23
Postdoctoral Associate, Duke University	2019–21
Associate, Analysis Group	2017–19

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics , <i>University of California, Los Angeles</i>	2017
MSc in Interdisciplinary Mathematics (with distinction), <i>University of Warwick</i>	2011
MSc in Economics (with distinction), <i>University of Warwick</i>	2009
BSc in Economics , <i>University of Nottingham</i>	2006

PUBLICATIONS

Race and home values in Durham, NC: 1940-2020
with Nick Datto, Pei Yi Zhuo, Clinton Boyd Jr, and William Darity Jr
Regional Science and Urban Economics, 2026.

The effects of community land trusts on neighborhood outcomes
with Sarah Raviola
Real Estate Economics, 2025.

Does anger drive populism?
with Klaus Desmet and Romain Wacziarg
Economics Bulletin, 2024.

On the Impact of Federal Housing Policies on Racial Inequality
AEA Papers and Proceedings, 2022.

The Association between Wealth Inequality and Socioeconomic Outcomes
with William Darity Jr, Avra Janz, and Marta Sanchez
AEA Papers and Proceedings, 2021.

WORKING PAPERS

Race, redistribution, and partisanship: evidence from the COVID-19 pandemic
Pablo Beramendi, William Darity Jr, and Monica Garcia-Perez

The Impact of Federal Housing Policies on Racial Inequality: the case of the Federal Housing Administration
Revise and resubmit at Journal of Public Economics

Inequality and Socioeconomic Outcomes
with William Darity Jr, Avra Janz, and Marta Sanchez

Disclosure in Multistage Projects

Stability in a many-to-one Matching Model with Positive Externalities among Colleagues
Revise and resubmit at International Journal of Game Theory

A Simple Model of Party Formation

WORK IN PROGRESS

The Distribution of Federally-Insured Mortgages, 1935-1975: Evidence from Local Land Records
with Jacob Faber, Andreas Ferrara, Jonathan Rose, Thomas Storrs, Katherine Thomas, Gabby Toborg, Randall Walsh, and Wenfei Xu

Discrimination and Economic Development
with Lukas Althoff

The Effects of Historically Black Colleges and Universities: Evidence from the Early 20th Century
with Andria Smythe and Randall Walsh

Housing Instability and Criminal Justice Involvement: Evidence From Evictions
with Cameron Drayton and Andrew Garin

Sites of settlement and extraction in the American city
Sunmi Jung

TEACHING

PhD Topics in Urban Economics — (with Randall Walsh) Fall 2024
Economics of Inequality — Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Fall 2025
Game Theory — Fall 2025

AWARDS AND GRANTS

The Distribution of Federally-Insured Mortgages: 1935-1975, Evidence from Local Land Records Washington Center for Equitable Growth (2025)
SES-2447083: Collaborative Research: Effects of government-insured mortgages (with Randall Walsh and Andreas Ferrara) National Science Foundation (2025)
Using municipal land records to reconstruct the initial patterns and evolution of redlining: 1935-1975 (with Randall Walsh and Andreas Ferrara) Russell Sage Foundation (2024)

Updated May 2026